

Digital Transformation & AI-Induced Change

Module 8 — Business AI in Practice · Notebook 26

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Contents

1 Why now

2 Tasks

3 Maturity

4 Strategies

5 Pitfalls

6 People

Outline

1 Why now

2 Tasks

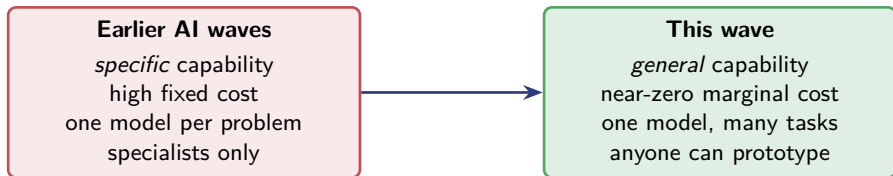
3 Maturity

4 Strategies

5 Pitfalls

6 People

Why AI feels different *this* time



- **Cheap intelligence** — an LLM call costs cents and needs no in-house ML team.
- **Natural-language interface** — an organisational change, not just a technical one.

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1 Why now

2 Tasks

3 Maturity

4 Strategies

5 Pitfalls

6 People

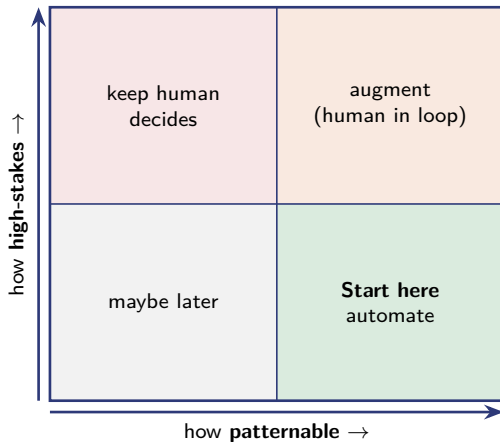
The unit of change: tasks, not jobs

- A job is a *bundle of tasks*. AI absorbs *tasks*, rarely whole jobs.
- Enumerate the tasks; score each; start where the win is safe and easy.

Reframe the stakeholder question

“Will AI replace these 12 people?” → “Which of their *tasks* will AI absorb, and what do the people do with the freed-up time?”

Where AI lands first — patternable × stakes

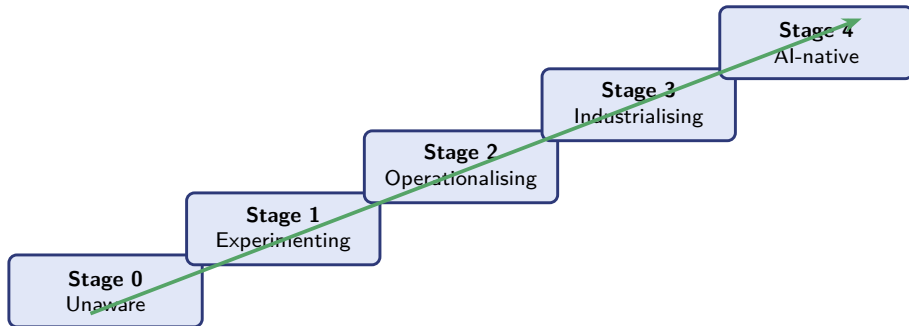


Begin in the **high-pattern** / **low-stakes** corner: cheap to build, cheap to be wrong.

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- 1 Why now
- 2 Tasks
- 3 Maturity**
- 4 Strategies
- 5 Pitfalls
- 6 People

The five-stage AI maturity model



Most organisations sit between **1** and **2**. The model names the *next realistic step* — not the destination.

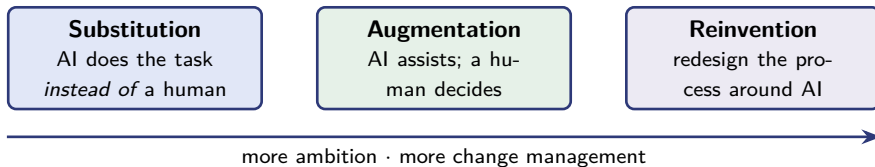
Maturity — the signature behaviour of each stage

#	Stage	Signature behaviour
0	Unaware	Not in the strategy; staff quietly use ChatGPT on their phones.
1	Experimenting	A few pilots in a sandbox; results stay in slides.
2	Operationalising	One or two features live in production, owned by a real team.
3	Industrialising	A platform team; reusable infra; a feature ships in weeks.
4	AI-native	AI is in the <i>process design</i> , not bolted on.

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- 1 Why now
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- 4 Strategies**
- 5 Pitfalls
- 6 People

Three change strategies



Intuition

Most real projects are **augmentation** in year one, drifting to **substitution** for the well-understood tasks as trust grows.

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- 4 Strategies
- 5 Pitfalls**
- 6 People

The five adoption pitfalls — and how to prevent them

Pitfall	Prevention
Solutionism	fix the process <i>before</i> you automate it
Pilot purgatory	define a production owner on day one
No monitoring	ship the eval dashboard <i>with</i> the feature
No change management	budget for adoption, training, incentives
Governance as afterthought	put ethics / safety in the first design review

“92 % accurate at launch” means nothing if nobody is watching the number six months later.

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1 Why now

2 Tasks

3 Maturity

4 Strategies

5 Pitfalls

6 People

The human side

- Job descriptions, skill mix, and team shape begin changing the *day you ship*.
- Frame the change as augmentation, and give people a one-click override.

The cheapest trust intervention

Publish the AI's **confidence score** next to every output. Users quickly learn when to trust it and when to double-check.

Companion notebook

This is the conceptual half of the lecture

The hands-on judgement — task inventories, placing an organisation on the maturity model, the pre-mortem, the strategy-map 2×2 — lives in **Notebook 26**, with worked solutions.

- Prerequisite-free; the course's *spiral* recommends it as an early read (the “why”).
- Next: **Notebook 27 — Architecture Patterns**.